Bhutto naïvely believed that he could intimidate Zia into releasing him from his hill station "guest house" prison in Murree, and he threatened to "hang Zia" for having dared to arrest him, bragging about it to old party friends who were detained with him in the same bugged house. But Zia had known from the day he arrested his prime minister that either Bhutto must hang or he would. So he very carefully prepared murder charges against Bhutto, using Zulfi's own chief of security, Masood Mahmood, who gave the crucial testimony that he had personally been ordered by Bhutto to "eliminate" his most vocal political opponent. The man gunned down by Masood's killers, however, was the innocent old father of Bhutto's political opponent Ahmad Raza Kasuri. In March 1978, Bhutto was judged guilty of murder by the Punjabi majority of Zia's high court.

"Martial law is darkness at high noon," Bhutto rightly argued at his trial. "It is neither an order nor a system. . . . This form of lawlessness takes us back to the law of the jungle. . . . Force, naked and brute, moody and mad, cannot be made the sole criterion of our honour." Zia was unmoved by Bhutto's eloquence. The devout general considered all Western culture and philosophy sinful and the primary cause of Pakistan's weakness. Purity of Islamic prayers and practice alone, he believed, could save Pakistan from Shaytan's temptations—imbibing alcohol and pork, having sex with loose women, watching films and naked dancing girls, all things Zulfi Bhutto enjoyed. Zia closed his eyes and ears to every appeal for clemency from President Jimmy Carter and other humane heads of state. On 4 April 1979, Zulfikar Ali Bhutto was hanged before dawn from gallows in Rawalpindi's dark prison fortress that would be torn down by his daughter soon after she became prime minister following Zia's death.

"The longer martial law remains the shorter will be the remaining life of Pakistan," Bhutto had prophesied from his death cell.

> Pakistan is decomposing very fast. In Europe there was *Balkanization*. Here, there will be *Bangladeshization*. The process is in motion. Thanks to Zia's follies it has been accelerated. . . . If I am not a part of Pakistan, in that case Sind is not a part of Pakistan. . . . There are no nightmares more dreadful than the last days of a usurper, of a man who stabs his own benefactor. Brutus did it to Caesar. . . . For over a year and a half I have been in solitary confinement. . . . I am the Rana [Lord] of not only Larkana but of the whole of Pakistan, and . . . certainly of Sind. . . . We are on a razor's edge.[5]